Ersatz

N = narrator; Y = you; R = your reflection; B = boyfriend; text in brackets = sound effect

N: Harsh, sterile light jumps off your bathroom walls as you look up from the sink, shutting off the tap, hands dripping.
N: Washing your face brought no refreshment this time. A veil of filthiness still clings to you.
N: A crawling, sticky thing like spider webs. Intuition, settling like dust, that something is wrong.
N: Your ghastly appearance hovers in the mirror. Tangled hair, pale, sickly skin, eyebags too dark to keep pretending they're not there.
N: You can't stand looking at yourself.
N: But you can't move, weighed down by a voracious black hole of dread.
N: You're frozen in place and time, silent as eternal winter spreads from your heart's icy core, glazing over your eyes until you can't recognize yourself in the glass.
N: In the mirror, that reflection—it distorts and warps like swirling shadows. It isn't you. It's something else.
N: It smiles.
R: You've been seeing things again.
N: You nod.
Y: I've been so tired lately.
Y: Doesn't matter how much I sleep. My head still feels like it's wrapped in gauze.
R: Sleep isn't what you need. It's too temporary.

Choice 1 >> Y: What do I need?
R: An end that's permanent.
R: So all this—the hallucinations, the misery—will go away.
Y: ...If only it were that easy.
R: But it is. If you listen to me. Join me.

Choice 2 >> Y: I know what I need.
Y: I just need to get better.
Y: To stop seeing things, stop feeling this way.
R: But these things will never change.
R: They're part of us—I'm part of you. One and the same.
R: The hallucinations, the misery—they'll be part of us forever.

N: A sound at the door distracts you. [Knocking sound effect plays]
B: Hey, are you almost ready?
B: If we don't leave soon, we'll be late, haha!
B: But no rush or anything! Take your time.
B: Anyway, I'm sure you look gorgeous as always.
N: You consider responding, but calling out to him would take too much effort. You feel carved from stone, stiff and lethargic.
R: You're still with him? How foolish.
Y: He's a good man.
R: Too good for you.
R: Why are you still wasting his time? Bringing him down like dead weight?
Y: ...

R: You haven't even told him about me.
Y: Not yet. I don't know how.
R: Because you can't. He'd never understand or accept it.
R: He's never seen *you*. Only your facade, the stone walls you put up around yourself, pretending to be normal all the time.
R: If he saw the real you—buried deep beneath all the *fucked up* layers of your mind—
R: If he saw *me*—he'd be *disgusted*.

Choice 1 >> Y: He doesn't know me at all...

N: You nod in shameful agreement.
N: Your heart feels heavy, like a stack of newspapers bound tight, weighing down your arms until you collapse in on yourself.
Y: I don't know what to do.
Y: I know I should leave him—free him—but I can't.
Y: I'm too selfish.
R: Exactly.

Choice 2 >> Y: No, he sees me.

N: You shake your head as tears prick at your eyes.
Y: You're underestimating him.
Y: Even if he doesn't know how fucked up I really am, he's always tried to help. He's always been there for me.
R: Because you're too useless to take care of yourself, so you need him to look after you, isn't that right?
Y: No!
R: All you do is take from him. *Need* and *want* and *take* and never stop.
R: And he keeps *giving*, pouring all his love and time and attention into you, but it's never enough.
R: He gives you all his light, but you just suck it in and grow darker.

R: You need more than he can give you. More than *anyone* could give you.
R: You're incomplete. Fundamentally lacking something to make you human.
R: What you really need is *me*.
R: That's why you keep ending up here, before this mirror, staring at yourself—at *me*. Self-obsessed, like Narcissus.
R: You are your own voyeur.

Choice 1 >> Y: No. You're wrong.

Y: I'm more like Echo, trapped here listening, mirroring what you say.
Y: But I shouldn't let you have power over me anymore.
N: Your reflection glares at you, but before it can speak, there's another sound at the door.

Choice 2 >> Y: You're right.

Y: How did I let this go on for so long?
R: You made mistakes. You were a mistake.
R: But it's okay, now. We can fix them. Together.
Y: ...
R: You know where he keeps the sleeping pills. Razors. Rope.

R: Pick one. And join me, on the other side.
R: Don't you see?
R: You were never meant for this world.
N: Buzzing rot chills you from the inside—hopelessness.
N: Like the lingering traces of a nightmare, when the events have faded from memory, but creeping horror still prickles your skin.
N: Before you can say anything, there's another sound at the door. [Knocking sound effect plays]

B: Hey, just... checking in again.
B: It kinda sounds like you're mumbling to yourself in there...
B: And... I saw you didn't take your anti-depressants today.
B: ...Are you okay?
B: I don't wanna bother you or anything, but... I'm just worried.
B: ...
B: Sometimes, it feels like I have to try so hard to reach out to you. Like you're always pushing me away, locking me out.
B: But...
B: I need you to know, I'll always be here for you. No matter what.
B: ...Can I know that you're there? Can you say something?
B: ...Please? ...Anything?
R: You know what to do.
N: You nod.

Ending 1 (Selected blue-coded choices two or more times):
Y: I need to get out. I need to make this all stop.
Y: And that starts with ignoring *you*.
R: ...What?
Y: There are people for me here, on my side. People who care for me, who *I* care for.
Y: I need to stay here, for them. To let them in. Only then can they help me out.
N: You tear your gaze away from the mirror, denying its power. You call out to your partner on the other side of the door.
Y: I'm ready now! Let's go.

Ending 2 (Selected red-coded choices two or more times):
Y: I'm just... so... tired.
N: Your body goes numb. You're floating out of it, away.
N: You watch yourself in third person through a blurry peephole, mind separated from body by a locked door.
N: You watch your reflection pull you into the mirror.
N: And then everything...
N: goes...
N: dark.
N: ... [Knocking sound effect plays]
B: ...Hello? ...Are you still in there...? Hello~?
N: ...Too little, too late.